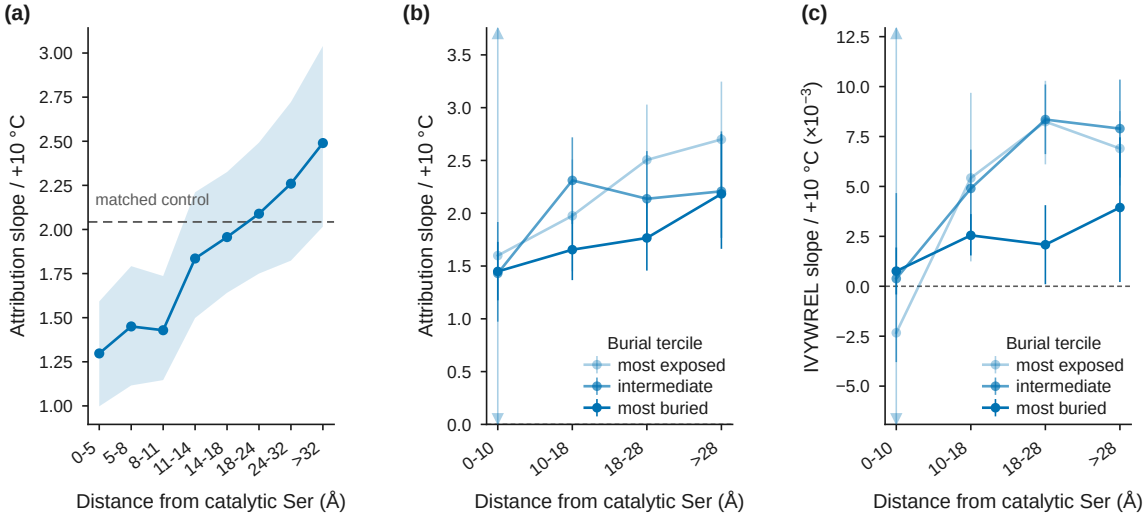The gradient is continuous and is not an exposure effect